

...that they are satisfied that fishing gives them a higher income and
...of living than their previous jobs even though some may have used
...employment to accumulate capital.

These big fishermen have more land than the other fishermen; 50 per cent
more than 52 daily have farms of over four acres, and 10 per cent of
more than 11 acres. This compares with over 50 per cent of fishermen
less than 52 daily with farms of less than three acres. The fishermen
tend to hire labourers and to grow cash crops, in particular
as tobacco, rice, beans, and pineapple, in addition to the
of maize, cassava, and millet. Thus, not only do these bigger farmers
from cash crops, but they need to use less of their income for
grains. They also own more cattle; 50 per cent of the fishermen
more than 52 daily own more than six head of cattle (the herds range in
to thirty-eight head) compared with only 6 per cent for the total sample
1970). Furthermore, these big fishermen own more businesses than other
men, the proportion increasing from under 10 per cent of those in the lower
groups to 45 per cent of those earning more than 52 daily. These
are canteens and stores. A small number of the canteen owners gave
gross earnings from this source as ranging between £1 and £9 a week;
completely none of the store owners gave comparable information.

Thus, to sum up, many of these big fishermen are successful entrepreneurs.
have exploited fishing more successfully than others, owning more expensive
and employing more labourers. Some gained the capital necessary for
gear from farming or outside employment, while others have worked their
up through fishing itself. This group of fishermen are those who gain most
the activities of the Fisheries Department on Lake Chilwa. Most recent in-
tion (mid-1972) showed that a few are in the process of buying motorised
and one or two already have catches large enough to sell direct to large
to Zambia and Rhodesia. They have exploited other spheres, too. They
of grain and cash crops, using paid labourers, often full-time, as
family labour. They also have larger herds of cattle. This is, in fact,
of all fishermen; the survey found that respondents of all ages
all income levels put cattle high on their list of desired goods. Cattle
a traditional form of holding wealth; but not only are they a natural bank,
can also be considered an investment in terms of the calves they produce
1951). Certainly for the big fishermen, cattle are a useful hedge
the risks involved in fishing in a lake subject to recession, as well as
varieties of climate and similar hazards affecting their crops. In addition,
are owners of small businesses such as canteens and stores.

These fishermen thus have a number of sources of income which can cross-
one each other. Here is field for further, intensive research: to find out
income flows from one interest to another, how the owner divides his time
them, how he delegates authority and decision-making, and other questions.
above, the spreading of economic interests and investment is of particular

Information on this was only partially elicited by the present survey
needs more detailed enquiry on an individual case-history basis.